

BIG DATA SMALL BYTES

Localisation and its importance

Big Data is an almost never-ending stream that can neither be stemmed nor contained. How do you make sense of it and how can you use it to your advantage? Let's find out.

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All forms of energy in the known universe have a tendency to seek a low energy state. If anything, it won't be too much of a stretch to say that all of physics is the study of energy conservation. Every particle or wave or atom or electron, everything seeks to reduce its energy state in some way or the other. The only reason a hydrogen atom exists is because the components that make up that atom find it more convenient to stick together than to roam free and thus, conserve energy.

You might be wondering why we're talking physics in an article that's almost entirely tied in to us and our data and our privacy, but rest assured, there's a point to be made here. The point we're trying to make (admittedly in a very roundabout fashion) is just this, as with every form of matter, our sole mission in life is to find

ways of expending less energy. The reason plastic spoons are so popular, despite being environmentally destructive, is that it's convenient for us to use them (because we don't need to make that extra effort to wash them and store them). As someone once said, if trees were to double as Wi-Fi antennae, we'd be living in a greener planet and spend more time in parks than at our PCs.

Big Business

The whole purpose of any business is to offer a product or service to the consumer that is a more convenient means of achieving some goal. Amazon a more convenient store, Google a more convenient search engine, Windows a more convenient OS, a non-stick pan a more convenient cooking utensil, Digit a more convenient technology fix; we could go on forever.

This is where Big Data comes in. Earlier, hitting on a revolutionary idea was as much a matter of intuition and luck as it was of research and analysis. That intuition was also a product of Big Data in a way, like Warren Buffett stating, "I look for simple businesses, with consistent performance, and favourable long-term prospects" when talking about his investment in Coke, a decision that any other investor would have balked at making at the time (for various reasons, including the fact that Coca Cola posted a 2% loss that same year). The data was there for everyone to access and it was, in fact, that very data which indicated to other investors that Coke was unworthy of much attention and investment.

As the previous story would have made abundantly clear to you, Big Data is just that, massive chunks of data that's